

Credit card companies are purveyors of the American Dream, to whomever they can sell it to. Not only is there irony in the fact that the bank launching this program is named the *Bank of America*, but another interesting tidbit of information is that President Bush's first Director of U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services from 2003–2005 was a man named Eduardo Aguirre. His job before that? He was president of international private banking for Bank of America. You connect the dots.

Nothing is sacred, and everyone is fair game. The credit card issuers are like junkies who will do anything for their next fix. They'll now take aim at target populations that, in years past, they would have been laughed out of the boardroom for even mentioning. Now, anything goes. If an executive, twenty years ago, would have said, "Let's go to the poor neighborhoods and the very poorest parts of the country, and let's get them to sign up for our cards," that employee would have been shown the door. Now he gets a bonus.

Exploiting the Impoverished

James Scurlock, the maker of the documentary feature-length film *Maxed Out*, states that the most shocking discovery for him was learning how the financial industry is exploiting the impoverished people of our nation. It is incredulous and sad. Scurlock maintains that the increase in these credit offers is actually causing poverty.

Instead of eating their Wheaties for breakfast, the big bucks lenders must eat something like "Greedies" to get them stoked for the day. Scurlock and his crew traveled with a journalist to New York, Pennsylvania, and Mississippi. In an MSNBC.com article by Jessica Bennett, Scurlock says, "If you had told me that Citigroup, one of the largest financial groups in the world, was trolling the backwoods of Mississippi for customers, I would have questioned your veracity. But they are; and they're finding people. They're going around very poor neighborhoods, in very poor parts of the country, finding people who have some home equity, finding people who have been responsible, who've saved, who have something left; and they're taking it from them."

Remember the mother and her son, who could not even sign his own name? Remember how they were faced with the prospect of losing